

TEACHING EFFECTIVENESS

Zihang Li

Auburn University • zzl0134@auburn.edu • zihangli.com

This document collects my evidence of teaching effectiveness in one file: my evaluation summary, my annotated sample syllabus, and the official Auburn University eValue reports for every course offering in the summary. Each entry below links to the first page of that part.

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Part 3 reproduces the reports as issued by Auburn University's eValue system.

TEACHING EVALUATION SUMMARY

Zihang Li

Auburn University • zzl0134@auburn.edu • zihangli.com

I have taught Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics as an independent instructor at Auburn University, with full course responsibility, and led Econometrics recitations as a teaching assistant. This summary presents end-of-term evaluations across seven course offerings, together with student comments and examples of how I use feedback to improve instruction.

End-of-term evaluation overview

Term	Course / role	Overall	Enrolled	Respondents	Response
Fall 2023	Microeconomics / instructor	4.37	33	32	96.97%
Spring 2024	Macroeconomics / instructor	5.21	42	37	88.10%
Fall 2024	Econometrics / TA	5.39	17	12	70.59%
Spring 2025	Microeconomics / instructor	5.33	25	20	80.00%
Fall 2025	Econometrics / TA	5.86	6	4	66.67%
Spring 2026	Macroeconomics / instructor	5.03	41	19	46.34%
Summer 2026	Microeconomics / instructor	5.30	20	16	80.00%

Scale: 1 = strongly disagree; 6 = strongly agree. Overall values are the source summary's averages of seven core items. Respondents are computed from enrollment and response rate. Instructor and TA ratings reflect different responsibilities and class sizes.

Ratings by core item

Core item	F23	S24	F24	S25	F25	S26	Su26
Student-instructor interaction	4.80	5.10	5.80	5.70	6.00	4.90	5.30
Peer collaboration	4.00	5.20	5.50	4.60	5.50	5.00	4.70
High academic expectations	4.30	5.20	5.50	5.10	6.00	5.10	5.40
Regular progress feedback	4.20	5.00	5.30	5.30	5.50	5.10	5.50
Application of concepts	4.40	5.30	5.40	5.50	6.00	5.20	5.30
Critical thinking	4.70	5.50	5.00	5.60	6.00	5.10	5.60
Support for success	4.20	5.20	5.20	5.50	6.00	4.80	5.30

F = fall; S = spring; Su = summer. F24 and F25 are Econometrics TA evaluations; all other columns are principles-course instructor evaluations. Item labels are abbreviated for space.

Reading the results in context

My principles ratings rose after my first independent course and have stayed between 5.03 and 5.33 since. Fall 2023 was my first time teaching a full course independently; its overall rating was 4.37. I prepared extensively, but I learned during that semester that every class date and each class's materials need to be set in advance, so I adjusted the pace while teaching. By my second course in Spring 2024, I knew what the course required, was more familiar with Auburn's course systems, and had students' feedback to build on; my later principles courses were rated 5.21 (Spring 2024), 5.33 (Spring 2025), 5.03 (Spring 2026), and 5.30 (Summer 2026). The Econometrics TA ratings were 5.39 in Fall 2024 and 5.86 in Fall 2025; the latter rests on 4 respondents in a six-student course.

Sources: official Auburn eValue reports, Fall 2023–Summer 2026. Comments are selected excerpts; an ellipsis marks omitted text. Midsemester results: ECON 2030 survey exports, April 1 and 3, 2026, Q25 (satisfaction with changes after Midterm 1); 17/18 = 94.4%.

Student comments on principles instruction

"I thought it was clever to use the news to apply our fairly basic principles to real world scenarios... I really liked the lecture where we changed teaching styles and used the game website and talked as a group."

Principles of Microeconomics, Spring 2025

"I liked how he always posted the class notes after class and how he went over the test questions after each exam... He was also very encouraging to ask questions."

Principles of Microeconomics, Spring 2025

"Professor Li is a really good teacher; his class is very structured, and he has helped me multiple times by going over previous tests and assignments, and by going over what I missed."

Principles of Macroeconomics, Spring 2026

"I appreciated the bonus problems and assignments, very helpful for exam prep."

Principles of Macroeconomics, Spring 2026

"I also felt that he paced the semester well and was agile in adjusting to meet our specific class' needs."

Principles of Macroeconomics, Spring 2024

"I did enjoy the slide handouts and walk-through lectures."

Principles of Microeconomics, Summer 2026

Student comments on empirical training and support

"Zihang was a great TA. He taught us how to code in R every Monday and provided every material we needed to succeed in the course."

Econometrics TA, Fall 2024

"Incredibly knowledgeable and easy to talk to... knew how to answer students' questions, even when the student had no idea what they were asking, providing feedback that removed prior doubts."

Econometrics TA, Fall 2024

"He was very flexible with his office hours and was very informative on research methods within the class and topics that we were researching."

Econometrics TA, Fall 2024

"He always answered questions, supported his students, and helped us to think critically about the material and our project."

Econometrics TA, Fall 2025

Turning feedback into course changes

In Spring 2026, I used repeated midsemester surveys to ask students about pacing, practice, and exam preparation. When students requested more practice problems, I reduced lecture time and expanded guided problem solving. In surveys collected after Midterm 2, **17 of 18 responses (94%)** were satisfied or very satisfied with the changes made after Midterm 1. These are response records across two survey rounds, not a verified count of distinct students or a measure of learning gains. One student wrote in the April 1 survey: *"Gives plenty of practice problems and examples. I enjoy when you incorporate real news/events."*

I also build tools and activities that give students more ways to practice and participate. In class I use my own free web games, *Oligopoly* in microeconomics and the *Tulip Bulb Investment Game* in macroeconomics, along with polls and Padlet; I built *Welfare Lab* in Summer 2026 for my next course. My completion of Auburn's Biggio Center Course (Re)Design Program in Summer 2024 and Summer 2026 helped me align these activities with learning objectives and assessments.

Annotated sample syllabus — Zihang Li. The ECON 2030 (Section 011, Spring 2026) syllabus below is reproduced exactly as I used it. The yellow **Teaching notes** are added for search committees: **Why** explains the purpose of a policy, and **In practice** describes how it worked in class.

PRINCIPLES OF MACROECONOMICS

ECON 2030 · Section 011 · Spring 2026

Monday, Wednesday & Friday, 12:00 PM – 12:50 PM · Miller Hall 230

Instructor Information

Name Zihang Li
Office Miller Hall, Room 106 D
Email zzl0134@auburn.edu
Office Hour Mon & Wed, 1:00 PM – 2:00 PM

Course Resources

Website canvas.auburn.edu
Textbook Mankiw, *Principles of Macroeconomics* (10th ed.)

⚠ Email Protocol: Please start all email subject lines with **ECON2030** for prompt response.

Course Description

Teaching note

Why. I want students to move from recognizing an economic term to using it to explain a mechanism or evaluate a policy argument. Each learning objective asks students to do something with a model, not only define it.

In practice. For the financial-system objective, I use the 2023 collapse of Silicon Valley Bank to ask what would have happened to depositors without deposit insurance, and then introduce why the FDIC and the Federal Reserve System were founded.

This course introduces students to macroeconomics' fundamental concepts and terminology, focusing on aggregate economic behavior and national economic dynamics. Topics include national income measurement, inflation, unemployment, monetary and fiscal policy, and international trade. By the end of the course, students will be proficient in applying economic models to real-world scenarios and equipped with analytical tools for effective decision-making regarding macroeconomic policy evaluation.

Learning Objectives

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Understand and apply core macroeconomic concepts including GDP, inflation, and unemployment
- Analyze the effects of monetary and fiscal policies on the economy
- Evaluate the role of financial systems in economic growth
- Apply macroeconomic principles to current economic events and policy debates
- Interpret economic data and use it to inform decision-making

Required Materials

Teaching note

Why. In my class, the slides are all students need to succeed, because I believe publishers are currently not doing a good job. I built my own interactive tools—the *Tulip Bulb Investment Game*, *Oligopoly*, and *Welfare Lab*—because publishers did not provide what I needed. Students can use these free tools to test their knowledge interactively, and I want publishers to provide what I cannot, so that a textbook makes the course better and justifies its cost. Some publisher tools, such as iClicker, are very good, and I plan to use them.

In practice. This course uses Mankiw's *Principles of Macroeconomics*. I have also used Michael Parkin's *Microeconomics* (Summer 2025 and Summer 2026), and I am currently a TA in a course that uses Hubbard and O'Brien's *Microeconomics*. With experience across several textbooks and publishers, I can adjust to a department's needs and requirements. I plan to keep building interactive tools, choosing topics by their importance, and I am glad to help other faculty build their own.

Textbook: *Principles of Macroeconomics* by N. Gregory Mankiw (any edition; 10th edition preferred)

Note: Class notes and lecture slides are sufficient to prepare for exams and assignments. My exams are lecture-based, so taking thorough notes in class will help you prepare well for tests.

Grading Policy

Teaching note

Why. Over the years, I have seen that some students do not perform well on exams because of limited time and stress, even though they work hard in every class. Performing poorly under pressure does not mean that a student did not study enough.

In practice. To reflect that, the assignments, which give students more time to work, carry the same share of the grade as the exams: 50% for assignments, against 30% for the two midterms and 20% for the final. I tell students that working hard and consistently throughout the semester matters, and that if they usually do not perform well on exams, they should aim for full credit on the assignments.

Grade Distribution

Component	Total	Counted	Percentage
Assignments	5	Best 4	$4 \times 12.5\% = 50\%$
Quizzes (Bonus)	4	Best 3	$3 \times 3.33\% = 10\%$
Midterm Exams	2	2	$2 \times 15\% = 30\%$
Final Exam	1	1	$1 \times 20\% = 20\%$
Total:			100% + 10% Bonus

Grading Scale

A	B	C	D	F
90–100%	80–89%	70–79%	60–69%	Below 60%

Examinations

Teaching note

Why. The index card asks students to decide which formulas and concepts matter most, which gives them a way to organize their review before each exam.

In practice. After each exam, I go over the questions in class so students can see which topics need more practice before the next one.

There will be two midterm exams and one comprehensive final exam. Students have the entire class period (50 minutes) for each exam. Midterm exams are not formally cumulative, but material builds on itself. The final exam is comprehensive.

Exam Schedule

Exam	Date	Time
Midterm 1	February 18	In class
Midterm 2	March 27	In class
Final Exam	April 30	10:30 AM – 12:30 PM

Note: This schedule may change according to class progress. Any changes will be announced in advance.

Exam Format & Requirements

- All exams consist of multiple-choice questions with some short answers
- **Closed book, closed notes**
- **Required materials:** Laptop/iPad, non-graphing calculator, pencil, eraser, and student ID
- Students arriving more than 15 minutes late will **not** be allowed to take the exam
- Cell phone apps **cannot** be used as calculators

📇 Notecards: Students may bring a 3"×5" index card (front & back) for each exam. Focus on formulas and concepts you found helpful during quizzes and assignments.

Make-Up Exams

Teaching note

Why. I design the make-up exam so that questions cannot leak from students who have already taken the regular exam.

In practice. In class, I tell students that if they truly have to miss a midterm, I need a legitimate excuse, and that the make-up exam will not be the same as the regular exam: it has similar questions but asks them to draw the graphs.

Students who miss a midterm exam for a legitimate, documented reason may take a make-up exam. Make-ups must be arranged **within one week** of the missed exam. There are **no make-up exams** for the final exam or quizzes.

Requirements:

- Written documentation is required for all excused absences
- Notify the instructor **before** the test day, or at the latest, the day after
- Notifications received three or more days after the test result in a zero

Assignments

There will be **five assignments** posted on Canvas. The best 4 out of 5 scores count toward your final grade.

- Assignments are typically open for one week
- **Late Policy:**
 - Within 24 hours: 50% credit
 - After 24 hours: Zero credit

Quizzes

There will be **four unannounced (pop) quizzes** during the semester. The best 3 out of 4 quiz scores will be added as **bonus points** (up to 10%).

- Quizzes are given during the first or last 20 minutes of class
- Each quiz consists of multiple-choice questions based on recent lectures
- **Missed quizzes cannot be retaken**

Attendance & Participation

Teaching note

Why. Attendance is not mandatory, and I do not take it. My students come from different backgrounds and have different schedules, so I want them to be able to succeed even if they miss some classes.

In practice. To be fair to students who come to every class, I give unannounced (pop) quizzes that count only as bonus points: only students who are in class can earn them, and a missed quiz cannot be made up. The quizzes also serve as a progress check before each exam. A student who misses most of the questions has nothing to worry about, because the points are a bonus, but the result is a clear reminder to come to office hours for help with material they find difficult.

While attendance is not formally graded, regular attendance is **strongly recommended**. Students who lack regular attendance often struggle to pass the class.

Expectations:

- Read relevant textbook material before and after lectures
- Take thorough notes during class
- Actively participate in discussions
- **Cell phones are not permitted during class or exams**



Seeking Help: Don't hesitate to ask questions! I recommend clarifying concepts early rather than waiting until the end of the course. Questions can be addressed at the end of class or during office hours.

Technology Requirements

Teaching note

Why. Lockdown Browser lets me make sure that no one is cheating during quizzes and exams, and it gives me a lot of flexibility: I can give each student the questions in a different order, or different versions of similar questions.

In practice. I ask students to install it, and the first quiz and all exams are proctored through it, with exams taken in the classroom. Before the first exam, I walk students through the setup to make sure Lockdown Browser works on their devices. If a student's device has problems, I always have paper copies of the exam ready, and I also provide the paper version to students who prefer it.

Lockdown Browser

Installation of Respondus Lockdown Browser is **required** for quizzes and exams taken in class.

Download Link:

<https://download.respondus.com/lockdown/download.php?id=313412015>

If the link doesn't work, copy and paste it directly into your browser.

Extra Credit

Teaching note

Why. I do not give extra credit to students who email me to ask for it, because I need to be fair to the other students.

In practice. In class, when I try something new or ask for volunteers, students who participate and fulfill the requirements earn 0.5% extra credit.

Additional extra credit may be available through class participation and attendance. **Individual extra credit requests via email will not be entertained.**

Academic Integrity

Auburn University has adopted an Honor System to promote academic integrity:

"We, the faculty, instructors, and students pledge to fulfill our mutual responsibilities to each other and the academic community at large with honor and integrity in order to build and maintain a climate of respect and trust that will enhance our research, teaching, and learning. We will support the Honor System of the School, and will not tolerate activities that undermine academic integrity."

Academic dishonesty will be reported to the Academic Honesty Committee. For more information, visit:

http://www.auburn.edu/student_info/student_policies/

Accessibility & Accommodations

Students who need accommodations should:

1. Submit approved accommodations electronically through AU Access
2. Arrange a meeting during the first week of classes (or as soon as accommodations are needed)
3. Contact the Office of Accessibility at 1228 Haley Center, (334) 844-2096

 For exam accommodations, notify the instructor **at least one week in advance**.
More details: <https://accessibility.auburn.edu/Student>

Mental Health & Well-Being

Teaching note

Why. I list campus resources and my own availability so that students know where to turn before stress affects their work.
In practice. I do not only list the resources; I also share my own experience with SCPS. I tell students about the Zen Den, where they can rest and calm down during the day: after they check in, one of two trained emotional support dogs will gently lie down near them and let them pet it, and they can also walk in and have a conversation with a doctor. I tell them I have been there myself and encourage them to visit if they need support. I also ask them to come talk to me if they think I can help; if I cannot help, I may know whom to contact to solve the problem.

If you are experiencing unmanageable stress during the semester, Auburn University's Student Counseling & Psychological Services (SCPS) offers various support services.

Contact Information:

- 📞 (334) 844-5123
- 📍 Bottom floor of Haley Center or 2nd floor of Auburn University Medical Clinic

As your instructor, I am available to discuss course-related stresses and can help connect you with campus resources.

Tentative Course Outline

Teaching note

Why. The sequence moves from measuring the economy to financial and monetary institutions, then to the models used for policy analysis, so later units build on earlier ones.

In practice. In Spring 2026, midsemester surveys showed that students wanted more practice, so after Midterm 1 I reduced lecture time and expanded guided problem solving. In surveys collected after Midterm 2, 17 of 18 response records across two survey rounds (94%) were satisfied or very satisfied with those changes.

Ch.	Topic
10	Measuring the Nation's Income
11	Measuring the Cost of Living
12	Production and Growth
13	Saving, Investment, and the Financial System
— Midterm 1 —	
14	The Basic Tools of Finance
15	Unemployment
16	The Monetary System
17	Money Growth and Inflation
— Midterm 2 —	
18	Open-Economy Macroeconomics: Basic Concepts
19	A Macroeconomic Theory of the Open Economy
20	Aggregate Demand and Aggregate Supply
21	The Influence of Monetary and Fiscal Policy on Aggregate Demand
— Comprehensive Final Exam —	

*This syllabus is subject to change at the instructor's discretion.
Students will be notified promptly of any changes via email.*

**Fall 2023 Survey
Fall 2023**

**Auburn University
1. Campus Wide**

Course:	ECON2020 016 - Prin Of Microeconomics	Department:	ECON
Responsible Faculty:	Zihang Li	Responses / Expected:	32 / 33 (96.97%)

University Questions		Zihang Li											
		Responses						Individual					
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev	
Q1	I was encouraged to interact with the instructor regarding course content (electronically, during office hours, in class, etc.).	8	12	10	1	0	1	32	4.8	5	5	1.06	
Q2	I was provided opportunities to cooperate with other classmates about course material (electronically, inside or outside of class, etc.).	5	9	7	6	2	3	32	4.0	4	5	1.48	
Q3	I was informed of the instructor's high expectations for my work in this course.	5	12	8	4	2	1	32	4.3	5	5	1.24	
Q4	I was provided with an evaluation of my academic progress at regular intervals during the semester.	4	13	6	5	2	2	32	4.2	5	5	1.36	
Q5	I was provided with ample opportunities to apply my learning in this course.	7	12	4	7	0	2	32	4.4	5	5	1.37	
Q6	I was prompted to think critically about the course material.	8	13	7	2	0	2	32	4.7	5	5	1.27	
Q7	I was provided an environment that supported my learning.	7	8	6	9	0	2	32	4.2	4	3	1.39	
Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1													

Q8 - Please provide additional actionable feedback related to instruction (strengths or areas of improvement).

Faculty:	Zihang Li
Response Rate:	62.50% (20 of 32)
1	Zihang Li was a great instructor that I could tell really cared for us understanding the material and doing well on his exams. I, for one, did not enjoy the multiple choice grading methods of the class however. Sometimes it felt as if some questions were worded vaguely (and I assume these questions are from some question bank). I feel like paper exams where I have to show my work would allow me to really show what I know. Granted, multiple choice may be easier grading wise/for students, I just think multiple choice doesn't allow students to display what we really know. Overall however, I think Zihang Li is doing a great job.
2	The problems that we were given on tests, quizzes, and assignments were so much more difficult than the examples we did in class.
3	The extra credit opportunities and being able to take a notecard for exams was super helpful but I am not a fan of the teacher style in this class. I needed to get tutored outside of class.
4	The biggest place I could see improvements being made would be to assign a group project or two. Any group work might have helped my understanding of some topics.
5	Teacher was really helpful during office hours and 1v1 meetings. For the future, other time slots should be available for bonus classes.
6	Strengths: He is very intentional of trying to teach further when students are confused.
7	Weakness: During class, there were multiple times of confusion. Professor was accommodating to students especially when health became an issue for assignments/tests. He ensured that everyone had a fair chance for all assignments and also had an opportunity to do better on assignments if not satisfied with the grade you got. I really appreciated this because it allowed for me to succeed in this class. Would take more classes from this professor but more than likely my major will not make it degree applicable
8	Professor Li's class was very difficult and his grading scale was weird. Hopefully, I don't end with a C. Had a D for the majority of the semester even though I studied and showed up to class. I think he gives so much bonus because everyone is doing so poorly. I did not like his class and microeconomics overall.
9	Needs to involve the class more and be more open about assignments
10	N/A
11	N/A
12	It was very hard to understand his lectures due to the language barrier.
13	Instruction during class would often be confusing and the teacher would often confuse himself on what he was teaching. I lost points on a test because his instructions were not clear.
14	I would have liked to done more problems in the real world to understand certain topics, and learn another way other than notes.
15	I feel this class did a great job at teaching me microeconomics!
16	I feel like maybe he should get people more involved during his class.
17	I enjoyed this class and the way it was taught. I took am economics last semester and I did not enjoy it but I really enjoyed this class.
18	Hard to understand him
19	Going over past assignments was very helpful. It would have been nice to know about the exams if they were going to be math-heavy or not.
20	Consistently has outside of class bonus meetings for extra credit

ECON_LA		Zihang Li									
		Responses					Individual				
		VS	S	M	W	VW	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q9	How do you generally view yourself as a student?	6	16	10	0	0	32	3.9	4	4	.70

Responses: [VS] Very Strong=5 [S] Strong=4 [M] Moderate=3 [W] Weak=2 [VW] Very Weak=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q10	The grading techniques were fair.	3	18	4	6	1	0	32	4.5	5	5	1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li									
		Responses					Individual				
		A	B	C	D	F	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q11	What grade do you currently expect to receive in this class?	5	17	10	0	0	32	3.8	4	4	.67

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q12	The instructor(s) explained course material clearly.	2	6	12	5	5	2	32	3.7	4	4	1.29

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		VL	L	SL	SU	U	VU	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q13	How likely are you to take another course from this instructor in the future?	1	4	5	7	6	9	32	2.8	3	1	1.48
Q14	How likely are you to take another economics course in the future?	9	10	2	2	2	7	32	4.0	5	5	1.93

Auburn University
1. Campus Wide

University Questions		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q1	I was encouraged to interact with the instructor regarding course content (electronically, during office hours, in class, etc.).	12	17	5	1	1	0	36	5.1	5	5	.91
Q2	I was provided opportunities to cooperate with other classmates about course material (electronically, inside or outside of class, etc.).	15	15	4	2	0	0	36	5.2	5	5,6	.84
Q3	I was informed of the instructor's high expectations for my work in this course.	16	11	9	0	0	0	36	5.2	5	6	.81
Q4	I was provided with an evaluation of my academic progress at regular intervals during the semester.	14	15	3	2	2	0	36	5.0	5	5	1.09
Q5	I was provided with ample opportunities to apply my learning in this course.	14	19	2	0	1	0	36	5.3	5	5	.79
Q6	I was prompted to think critically about the course material.	20	14	2	0	0	0	36	5.5	6	6	.60
Q7	I was provided an environment that supported my learning.	15	14	5	2	0	0	36	5.2	5	6	.87

Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1

Faculty: Zihang Li	
Response Rate:	40.54% (15 of 37)
1	none
2	clear directions; class time managed well
3	awesome class
4	Would have liked to see more in-class discussions between class mates.
5	Very caring instructor that was focused on helping students learn more than just giving out grades, which I appreciated. Mr. Li is very knowledgeable on this course's material, and explained it well. I also felt that he paced the semester well and was agile in adjusting to meet our specific class' needs.
6	The only thing I would change about this course is having 3 test before the final so the information is more spread out.
7	Overall good for an into level class. Powerpoints were they key to success and were done well.
8	Not to much to say about how you can improve your teaching because there is not much to improve.
9	Mr. Li was helpful.
10	Mr. Li is a phenomenal teacher who really cares about each students well being, while this is a very difficult course, he makes it fun to learn!
11	I think when we are scheduled to take a test on certain chapters, instead of going to the next chapters, we review the chapters until the test. I think a way to have others engages in the class bus instead of waiting for a volunteer to answer questions, just call on them.
12	I think professor Li could improve his slideshows/lectures and include more examples
13	Great teaching and overall course I enjoyed it
14	Great teacher, he knew a lot about the content making it easy for him to explain.
15	Class was too hard for an introductory class. But, the grading policy was a little easier to counteract that.

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q10	The grading techniques were fair.	20	12	2	3	0	0	37	5.3	6	6	.90

Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li									
		Responses					Individual				
		A	B	C	D	F	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q11	What grade do you currently expect to receive in this class?	9	18	9	1	0	37	3.9	4	4	.77

Responses: [A] A=5 [B] B=4 [C] C=3 [D] D=2 [F] F=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q12	The instructor(s) explained course material clearly.	12	16	3	2	3	0	36	4.9	5	5	1.17

Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		VL	L	SL	SU	U	VU	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q13	How likely are you to take another course from this instructor in the future?	12	11	6	2	2	2	35	4.7	5	6	1.43
Q14	How likely are you to take another economics course in the future?	10	13	6	1	4	1	35	4.6	5	5	1.38

Responses: [VL] Very Likely=6 [L] Likely=5 [SL] Slightly Likely=4 [SU] Slightly Unlikely=3 [U] Unlikely=2 [VU] Very Unlikely=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q12	The instructor(s) explained course material clearly.	5	4	1	1	0	1	12	4.8	5	6	1.46

Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		VL	L	SL	SU	U	VU	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q13	How likely are you to take another course from this instructor in the future?	5	0	2	0	1	1	9	4.6	6	6	1.83
Q14	How likely are you to take another economics course in the future?	8	0	0	0	0	0	8	6.0	6	6	0

Responses: [VL] Very Likely=6 [L] Likely=5 [SL] Slightly Likely=4 [SU] Slightly Unlikely=3 [U] Unlikely=2 [VU] Very Unlikely=1

Spring 2025 Survey
Spring 2025

Auburn University
1. Campus Wide

Course:	ECON2020 010 - Prin Of Microeconomics	Department:	ECON
Responsible Faculty:	Zihang Li	Responses / Expected:	20 / 25 (80%)

University Questions		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q1	I was encouraged to interact with the instructor regarding course content (electronically, during office hours, in class, etc.).	13	7	0	0	0	0	20	5.7	6	6	.48
Q2	I was provided opportunities to cooperate with other classmates about course material (electronically, inside or outside of class, etc.).	6	5	5	2	2	0	20	4.6	5	6	1.28
Q3	I was informed of the instructor's high expectations for my work in this course.	6	9	4	0	0	0	19	5.1	5	5	.72
Q4	I was provided with an evaluation of my academic progress at regular intervals during the semester.	10	6	2	1	0	0	19	5.3	6	6	.86
Q5	I was provided with ample opportunities to apply my learning in this course.	12	5	3	0	0	0	20	5.5	6	6	.74
Q6	I was prompted to think critically about the course material.	13	6	1	0	0	0	20	5.6	6	6	.58
Q7	I was provided an environment that supported my learning.	13	3	4	0	0	0	20	5.5	6	6	.80
Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1												

Q8 - Please provide additional actionable feedback related to instruction (strengths or areas of improvement).

Faculty:	Zihang Li
Response Rate:	60.00% (12 of 20)
1	The class was kind of boring but the instructor did a great job and was very approachable
2	More assignments
3	Maybe have some sort of incorporated class interaction between students during lecture to help keep students engaged more especially in a longer period class block early in the morning.
4	Li, You are truly a fantastic professor, I would not wish to take economics with another lecturer. Even though this is a required course in my major, and the only economics course I will take at AU, I have a newfound appreciation for the study of economics and the beauty of its logic. It's clear you are passionate about economics and want to share that passion with us and help us understand the course content and apply it in current events. I thought it was clever to use the news to apply our fairly basic principles to real world scenarios. The little glimpses into the harder and more complex economics topics you've learned were enriching. I really liked the lecture where we changed teaching styles and used the game website and talked as a group. I think it is a good idea to do that kind of class occasionally, especially in the beginning of the semester, to make everyone get more familiar and comfortable. This was a very memorable class, and your teaching style is very good at simplifying concepts in a way that doesn't require memorization, but critical reasoning. I will not forget the economics fundamentals I've learned in this class. As far as areas of improvement, I found that the quizzes sometimes brought more stress than necessary. I think that perhaps doing another optional quiz or making the quiz in the beginning of class may relieve some additional stress that could help student focus on the lecture, not preparing for a quiz. You could also consider a questionnaire tool like tophat or iclicker. I liked how you gave multiple attempts on the assignments, to help ease students in you could give three attempts for the first assignment perhaps. I also would have liked if the lecture slides were posted prior to the class, and most days they were. Overall, thank you for being a great teacher, I hope you had as much fun as I did.
5	I thought it was good
6	I think he did his absolute best to work with a class that was unfortunately very quiet and disengaged. Despite that I really enjoyed the class and felt he did a great job as a professor. I liked how he always posted the class notes after class and how he went over the test questions after each exam, which is something I wish more professors would do. He was also very encouraging to ask questions and to contact him if needed all throughout the semester. I can't think of anything I'd do differently about in-class teaching, but one potential recommendation I have is that maybe instead of having 6 periodic assignments, we have 1 short one after each class that's like 10 questions that reflects what we just learned that day. I think this would help students retain the information from class better and would also provide sort of a cushion on grades so that they aren't just based off of quizzes and exams and a few assignments. I think in this format we could also still have those 6 longer periodic assignments because they also do a great job at helping review before exams/quizzes just maybe they could be optional or something. With that being said that's only an idea that I thought of and not a critique of the class at all.
7	I loved the way he explained things. The only thing I would change would be maybe more assignments. I don't like homework as much as the next person, but working on something maybe even over the course of a week instead of big assignments covering multiple chapters may have helped me understand the concepts better. Other than that he was great!
8	I liked how the notes/slides were shared before class, so I could download them and be ready to follow along during instruction. I wish we had gone over more problems similar to the ones on midterms and quizzes in class. I liked the assignments because they were similar, but we only had one/two per midterm, so it was a little tricky to prepare. I also wish we had review days the class before a midterm that gave us those similar problems. In class was all concepts but the test questions were applying those concepts and I think more practice applying would have helped.
9	He is very straightforward and love the grading policy
10	He gave many opportunities to ask questions, comments, or concerns. Not only in person but through multiple forms of outreach.
11	He does a great job reviewing topics at the beginning of class that we learned in the previous class and always ensures that we understand the topics.
12	Ample opportunities to correct any of a student's mistakes on quizzes / tests.

ECON_LA		Zihang Li									
		Responses					Individual				
		VS	S	M	W	VW	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q9	How do you generally view yourself as a student?	6	9	5	0	0	20	4.1	4	4	.74

Responses: [VS] Very Strong=5 [S] Strong=4 [M] Moderate=3 [W] Weak=2 [VW] Very Weak=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q10	The grading techniques were fair.	12	7	0	1	0	0	20	5.5	6	6	.74

Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li									
		Responses					Individual				
		A	B	C	D	F	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q11	What grade do you currently expect to receive in this class?	7	13	0	0	0	20	4.4	4	4	.48

Responses: [A] A=5 [B] B=4 [C] C=3 [D] D=2 [F] F=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q12	The instructor(s) explained course material clearly.	9	5	5	1	0	0	20	5.1	5	6	.94

Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1

ECON_LA							Zihang Li										
							Responses					Individual					
							VL	L	SL	SU	U	VU	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q13	How likely are you to take another course from this instructor in the future?						6	4	5	1	0	1	17	4.7	5	6	1.32
Q14	How likely are you to take another economics course in the future?						7	0	1	1	3	6	18	3.4	2.5	6	2.21

Responses: [VL] Very Likely=6 [L] Likely=5 [SL] Slightly Likely=4 [SU] Slightly Unlikely=3 [U] Unlikely=2 [VU] Very Unlikely=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		VL	L	SL	SU	U	VU	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q13	How likely are you to take another course from this instructor in the future?	3	0	0	0	0	0	3	6.0	6	6	0
Q14	How likely are you to take another economics course in the future?	3	0	0	0	0	0	3	6.0	6	6	0

Responses: [VL] Very Likely=6 [L] Likely=5 [SL] Slightly Likely=4 [SU] Slightly Unlikely=3 [U] Unlikely=2 [VU] Very Unlikely=1

Auburn University
1. Campus Wide

University Questions		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q1	I was encouraged to interact with the instructor regarding course content (electronically, during office hours, in class, etc.).	7	7	3	1	0	1	19	4.9	5	5,6	1.25
Q2	I was provided opportunities to cooperate with other classmates about course material (electronically, inside or outside of class, etc.).	8	7	2	1	0	1	19	5.0	5	6	1.26
Q3	I was informed of the instructor's high expectations for my work in this course.	7	8	3	1	0	0	19	5.1	5	5	.85
Q4	I was provided with an evaluation of my academic progress at regular intervals during the semester.	7	9	1	1	1	0	19	5.1	5	5	1.05
Q5	I was provided with ample opportunities to apply my learning in this course.	9	8	1	0	0	1	19	5.2	5	6	1.15
Q6	I was prompted to think critically about the course material.	8	8	1	1	0	1	19	5.1	5	5,6	1.23
Q7	I was provided an environment that supported my learning.	7	6	4	1	0	1	19	4.8	5	6	1.27
Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1												

Faculty:	Zihang Li
Response Rate:	57.89% (11 of 19)
1	Quick quizzes allowed for participation.
2	Professor Li is a really good teacher; his class is very structured, and he has helped me multiple times by going over previous tests and assignments, and by going over what I missed. I would 100% take Professor Li again if I were in an economics major or if he were a teacher option!
3	Professor Li did an amazing job explaining everything and made sure that the material was clear before moving on.
4	Material could be confusing at times, but extra practice problems helped
5	I think the class is run to perfection
6	I think his strengths are making students think about the course material and the effects of what is going on in the lecture scenarios.
7	I think he did a great job helping students interact within the classroom to stay learning and paying attention. As well trying to make sure students knew what they were doing and learning.
8	I appreciated the bonus problems and assignments, very helpful for exam prep.
9	He was a great teacher. Made class very understandable and plenty of opportunities to help our grade.
10	Great teacher but goes over class time. If class ends at 12:50, he will go 1-2 minutes over time. Overall amazing professor and good grading system.
11	Dr. Li was good at going over material many times and asking the class questions. However many times, he would ask questions in a way that was confusing. Asking "why do you think that" is a good questions to help students think about the why behind an answer, but often you didn't know the answer he was looking for and that could be hard to navigate. Presentations were very simple and clear. Very lenient grading and understanding with assignments.

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q10	The grading techniques were fair.	12	6	1	0	0	0	19	5.6	6	6	.59

Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li									
		Responses					Individual				
		A	B	C	D	F	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q11	What grade do you currently expect to receive in this class?	17	2	0	0	0	19	4.9	5	5	.31

Responses: [A] A=5 [B] B=4 [C] C=3 [D] D=2 [F] F=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		VL	L	SL	SU	U	VU	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q13	How likely are you to take another course from this instructor in the future?	8	3	3	1	2	1	18	4.6	5	6	1.60
Q14	How likely are you to take another economics course in the future?	3	5	3	2	4	1	18	3.9	4	5	1.56

Responses: [VL] Very Likely=6 [L] Likely=5 [SL] Slightly Likely=4 [SU] Slightly Unlikely=3 [U] Unlikely=2 [VU] Very Unlikely=1

Auburn University
1. Campus Wide

University Questions		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q1	I was encouraged to interact with the instructor regarding course content (electronically, during office hours, in class, etc.).	9	6	0	0	0	1	16	5.3	6	6	1.21
Q2	I was provided opportunities to cooperate with other classmates about course material (electronically, inside or outside of class, etc.).	5	3	3	1	0	1	13	4.7	5	6	1.43
Q3	I was informed of the instructor's high expectations for my work in this course.	8	7	1	0	0	0	16	5.4	5.5	6	.61
Q4	I was provided with an evaluation of my academic progress at regular intervals during the semester.	9	6	1	0	0	0	16	5.5	6	6	.61
Q5	I was provided with ample opportunities to apply my learning in this course.	8	7	0	0	1	0	16	5.3	5.5	6	.98
Q6	I was prompted to think critically about the course material.	10	6	0	0	0	0	16	5.6	6	6	.48
Q7	I was provided an environment that supported my learning.	7	8	0	1	0	0	16	5.3	5	5	.77

Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1

Faculty: Zihang Li	
Response Rate: 62.50% (10 of 16)	
1	things weren't super interactive
2	With a mini summer semester, I understand it is difficult to fit the entire curriculum within the time span. However, making sure quizzes are available before the test and allowing ample time to do them in order to study would be recommended.
3	Very enjoyable and informational class
4	Nothing the class was great
5	Maybe just a few more graded assignments to make quizzes less stressful.
6	I think I was prepared overall for the quizzes and midterms because of the course material.
7	I had every opportunity to be great in this class
8	Great work for a summer semester wasn't a weak class i felt i learnt what i needed from the class.
9	Excellent mastery of the subject matter, the lectures were straight forward and you made the lessons easy to understand.
10	As a thought, I remember that doing my assignments on ALEKS was very helpful, as it guided the learning in addition to videos. The only issue with that is that the workload might be too much for a mini-semester. I did enjoy the slide handouts and walk-through lectures.

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q10	The grading techniques were fair.	6	9	0	1	0	0	16	5.3	5	5	.75

Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1

ECON_LA						Zihang Li									
						Responses					Individual				
						A	B	C	D	F	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q11	What grade do you currently expect to receive in this class?					14	2	0	0	0	16	4.9	5	5	.33

Responses: [A] A=5 [B] B=4 [C] C=3 [D] D=2 [F] F=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		SA	A	SA	SD	D	SD	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q12	The instructor(s) explained course material clearly.	10	5	0	0	1	0	16	5.4	6	6	1

Responses: [SA] Strongly Agree=6 [A] Agree=5 [SA] Slightly Agree=4 [SD] Slightly Disagree=3 [D] Disagree=2 [SD] Strongly Disagree=1

ECON_LA		Zihang Li										
		Responses						Individual				
		VL	L	SL	SU	U	VU	N	Mean	Med.	Mode	Std Dev
Q13	How likely are you to take another course from this instructor in the future?	9	3	0	0	1	1	14	5.1	6	6	1.55
Q14	How likely are you to take another economics course in the future?	5	5	1	2	1	2	16	4.3	5	5,6	1.72

Responses: [VL] Very Likely=6 [L] Likely=5 [SL] Slightly Likely=4 [SU] Slightly Unlikely=3 [U] Unlikely=2 [VU] Very Unlikely=1